

[and] promotes a healthy and viable mutual fund complex within which each fund can better prosper.

In every respect, the Commission's parting salute was to prove prescient.

So the diamonds weren't going to Boston. They were at last permanently in our hands—or, far more accurately, in the hands of our shareholders, remaining where they belonged, in Greater Philadelphia, birthplace of Wellington in 1928 and of Vanguard in 1974. You might think that the store of diamonds in my Golconda was at last exhausted. But miraculously, there proved to be yet another diamond awaiting my discovery.

A Change of Heart

Paradoxically, the next diamond I was to discover, also right in my own backyard, was in the form of a new heart. (As we all know, in card games a heart beats a diamond every time. It's true in life, too!) I had been struggling with a failing heart since my first attack, of dozens, in 1960. By 1995, time had almost run out; only half my heart was still pumping. That fall, I entered Philadelphia's Hahnemann Hospital, and on February 21, 1996, I at last received my new heart, only months, or perhaps weeks or even days, before my own tired heart would have expired. I had waited in the hospital for 128 days, connected around the clock to an intravenous line feeding me heart-stimulating drugs.

Strangely, despite the traumatic circumstances, I never thought I would die. I never thought I would live, either. It just didn't seem sensible to think about the outcome either way. But live I did, and with the heart that now beats in my body—the gift of life from an anonymous donor—and through the care of the doctors and nurses who have been my guardian angels, I have enjoyed superb health for what has now been more than a dozen years, one more reason why I am convinced that I have received more blessings—more